



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	04/02/2026	Time of Incident	4:00 PM
Directorate / Region	South West Region	Main Roads or Contractor	Main Roads
Event Type	Near Miss	isafe Incident Number	INC-000039
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	A Heavy Maintenance Road Worker experienced a micro-sleep while driving in convoy
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Executive Summary

At approximately 1600hrs on Wednesday, 4 February 2026, a Heavy Maintenance Road Worker was travelling southbound along South Western Highway, Brunswick, as part of a convoy. The convoy was travelling at an estimated speed of approximately 50 km/h.

The posted speed limit in the area is 60 km/h, however, the location is adjacent to a designated school crossing zone. The school zone period had concluded at 4:00pm, and the applicable speed limit at the time of the incident was 60 km/h.

During travel, the Heavy Maintenance Road Worker claims to have experienced a microsleep, resulting in a momentary loss of vehicle control. The vehicle veered to the left, travelled up the kerb and onto the verge, and the front passenger side window struck a "Children Crossing" sign. The impact caused damage to the passenger-side mirror. The collision prompted the driver to regain alertness, correct the steering, and return the vehicle to the roadway.

No injuries were sustained as a result of the incident. The vehicle remained drivable however, the incident was not reported in accordance with the Incident Management Procedure.

Contributing Factors

- No formal fatigue reassessment or Fatigue Checklist completed following job cancellation and site relocation.
- Extended driving distances without mandatory, planned, documented rest and walk around breaks.
- Solo driving arrangements with HC Truck with no opportunity for shared driving or in cab fatigue monitoring.
- Delayed incident reporting prevented timely escalation and implementation of controls
- The Road Worker continued to drive despite increasing fatigue levels later in the day.
- The Road Worker advised this was the first time such an event had occurred.

- Limited number of HC licenced personnel increased reliance on a small crew and extended driving responsibilities.
- No formal end of day fitness for work checks or mandatory fatigue reassessment procedures in place.

Corrective Actions

- Reinforce planned rest and walk around breaks for lengthy driving periods within Daily Pre-start especially for heavy vehicles.
- Increase the number of personnel holding HC licences and utilise increased staffing at the Donnybrook Depot to reduce reliance on a limited number of drivers and improve fatigue management through the availability of a passenger where practicable.
- Ensure any unroadworthy vehicle is immediately removed from service and that crews and supervisors are empowered to stop, cancel, or reschedule works when vehicle safety is compromised.
- Provide UNIQCO training for all relevant personnel, transition to mandatory electronic plant and truck pre-starts to reduce reliance on paper based "tick and flick" processes and encourage use of the Get Home Safe App when required.
- Review and update the Fatigue Management Procedure to address fatigue, long distance travel, work changes and end of shift reassessment, develop and communicate a clear after hours incident reporting flowchart with emergency contacts.
- Toolbox and Safety Moments to reinforce expectations that all incidents and near misses are reported immediately regardless of when they occur.
- Strengthen work planning and site inspection verification to prevent mobilisation to unsafe or uninspected sites.

Additional Issues / Learnings



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Vehicles and Driving**

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations